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DA541A Laboratory report

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1. Lab 1

This is the first lab assignment for the course “Data Communication and Networks” (DA541A HT26). Here I will answer a total of nine questions regarding the location my IP address, MAC address and DNS server address, mappings between domain names and IP addresses and the handling of the DNS cache.

All answers come from tests, tasks and experiments done in this environment.

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ hostnamectl
 Static hostname: desktop-0
       Icon name: computer-laptop
         Chassis: laptop 💻
      Deployment: pc:development:server
        Location: LGH 1102, Muskotgatan 18, Gothenburg, Sweden
      Machine ID: 22d1d6fd024b486cbf4264741dfd0fb3
         Boot ID: 0c017eaab5e34d57ab4dd59c12df7d32
Operating System: Ubuntu 24.04.5 LTS
          Kernel: Linux 7.0.0-34-generic
    Architecture: x86-64
 Hardware Vendor: Micro-Star International Co., Ltd.
  Hardware Model: GE60 20C_20D_20E
Firmware Version: E16GCIMS.511
   Firmware Date: Tue 2013-08-27
    Firmware Age: 13y 1month 3w 1d
```

1.1 Answer to question 1

My computers local IP address is ”192.168.0.137”.

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ ip address show | sed -n '9p'
    inet 192.168.0.137/24 brd 192.168.0.255 scope global noprefixroute enp3s0
```

1.2 Answer to question 2

My local configured DNS server address is “192.168.0.1”.

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ resolvectl status enp3s0
Link 2 (enp3s0)
    Current Scopes: DNS
         Protocols: +DefaultRoute -LLMNR -mDNS -DNSOverTLS DNSSEC=no/unsupported
Current DNS Server: 192.168.0.1
       DNS Servers: 192.168.0.1
```

It is used for translating domain names into IP addresses.

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1.3 Answer to question 3

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ nslookup www.MIT.edu
Server:         127.0.0.53
Address:        127.0.0.53#53

Non-authoritative answer:
www.MIT.edu     canonical name = www.mit.edu.edgekey.net.
www.mit.edu.edgekey.net canonical name = e9566.dscb.akamaiedge.net.
Name:   e9566.dscb.akamaiedge.net
Address: 88.221.97.35
Name:   e9566.dscb.akamaiedge.net
Address: 2a02:26f0:9500:1399::255e
Name:   e9566.dscb.akamaiedge.net
Address: 2a02:26f0:9500:1398::255e
```

1. The DNS server IP address for this name resolution is “127.0.0.53”, which is my computers own name resolver.

2. The IP addresses for the host www.MIT.edu are “88.221.97.35”, “2a02:26f0:9500:1399::255e” and “2a02:26f0:9500:1398::255e”.

3. Yes, www.MIT.edu is an alias.

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ nslookup www.MIT.edu | sed -n '5p'
www.MIT.edu     canonical name = www.mit.edu.edgekey.net.
```

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1.4 Answer to question 4

These are the DNS servers responsible for domain names in “mit.edu”.

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ nslookup -type=NS mit.edu
Server:         127.0.0.53
Address:        127.0.0.53#53

Non-authoritative answer:
mit.edu nameserver = asia1.akam.net.
mit.edu nameserver = ns1-37.akam.net.
mit.edu nameserver = asia2.akam.net.
mit.edu nameserver = usw2.akam.net.
mit.edu nameserver = use2.akam.net.
mit.edu nameserver = use5.akam.net.
mit.edu nameserver = ns1-173.akam.net.
mit.edu nameserver = eur5.akam.net.
```

Below are shown the IP addresses of the DNS servers above.

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ nslookup -type=NS mit.edu \
> | awk '/nameserver/ {print $4; system("dig +short " $4)}'
asia1.akam.net.
95.100.175.64
asia2.akam.net.
95.101.36.64
use5.akam.net.
2.16.40.64
ns1-37.akam.net.
193.108.91.37
eur5.akam.net.
23.74.25.64
ns1-173.akam.net.
193.108.91.173
usw2.akam.net.
184.26.161.64
use2.akam.net.
96.7.49.64
```

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1.5 Answer to question 5

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ nslookup hkr.se 8.8.8.8
Server:         8.8.8.8
Address:        8.8.8.8#53

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:   hkr.se
Address: 194.47.45.20
Name:   hkr.se
Address: 2001:6b0:3e:b29::157

durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ nslookup www.hkr.se 8.8.8.8
Server:         8.8.8.8
Address:        8.8.8.8#53

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:   www.hkr.se
Address: 194.47.45.20
```

1. The DNS server used for the nameresolution of www.hkr.se is assigned by the IP address at the end of the command, namely “8.8.8.8”.

2. No, I do not find any IPv6 addresses on ‘www.hkr.se’, but I do find one on ‘hkr.se’.

1.6 Answer to question 6

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ nslookup 220.135.143.45
45.143.135.220.in-addr.arpa     name = 220-135-143-45.hinet-ip.hinet.net.
```

Yes, the long name for 220.135.143.45 does cause inconvenience for users. Mainly because it is harder to remember, error prone and takes longer to type out.

1.7 Answer to question 7

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ nslookup  -type=mx  hkr.se
Server:         127.0.0.53
Address:        127.0.0.53#53

Non-authoritative answer:
hkr.se  mail exchanger = 10 hkr-se.mail.protection.outlook.com.
```

E-mail addressed to sandra.roos@hkr.se is sent to ‘hkr-se.mail.protection.outlook.com’.

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1.8 Answer to question 8

1. These are the IP addresses that I found for the queries in the assignment.

```
durim@desktop-0:~$ nslookup www.google.com
Server:         127.0.0.53
Address:        127.0.0.53#53

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.153.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.156.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.151.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.154.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.150.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.155.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.157.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.152.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482d:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4827:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482a:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4826:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4828:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482b:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482c:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4829:7700::
```

```
durim@desktop-0:~$ nslookup www.google.com 8.8.8.8
Server:         8.8.8.8
Address:        8.8.8.8#53

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.154.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.157.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.155.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.151.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.152.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.156.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.150.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.153.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482a:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4828:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482d:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482c:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4829:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4827:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482b:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4826:7700::
```

```
durim@desktop-0:~$ nslookup www.google.com 208.67.222.222
Server:         208.67.222.222
Address:        208.67.222.222#53

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.151.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.152.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.153.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.154.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.155.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.156.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.157.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 142.251.150.119
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4826:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4827:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4828:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:4829:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482a:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482b:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482c:7700::
Name:   www.google.com
Address: 2001:4860:482d:7700::
```

2. A DNS service can support load balancing by having several IP-addresses for one hostname. The first address to be returned is the one that is contacted. And as evidenced by the differing order of addresses, the first IP-address to be returned is not always the same. The first IP-address to be returned is assumed to be the one under the least amount of load, or the one that is closest to the requester.

1.9 Answer to question 9

Thirty-six domain names have been cached on my computer.

```
durim@desktop-0:~/.../datacom/labs$ sudo resolvectl show-cache \
> | awk '$2 == "IN" {print $1}' \
> | wc -l
36
```

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2. Lab 2

This is the second lab assignment for the course “Data Communication and Networks” (DA541A HT26). Here I will answer a total of nine question regarding the principles behind switch operations, including basic configurations, functions and purposes of static and dynamic routing.

All answers come from tests, tasks and experiments done in the environment referred to in the introduction to lab 1.

2.1 Answer to question 1

The switch enters ‘user EXEC’ mode on startup. I recognize it by the ‘greater than’ (>) symbol following the hostname.

2.2 Answer to question 2

The mode indicates that the host has the ability to change the configurations of the switch. It is reached by first entering “privileged EXEC” mode (as shown by the hash symbol) with the command “enable”, and afterwards by entering the command “configure terminal” which displays the substring “(config)”.

2.3 Answer to question 3

It is necessary because the configurations are not set in persistent memory when changed. If the configuration file is not saved, the changes will be lost when the switch restarts or its power supply is cut.

2.4 Answer to question 4

It shows the size of the current configuration, the software’s version number, log and debug info with timestamps, the password set by the “password” command, the hostname and the connection status of the switch’s interfaces.

2.5 Answer to question 5

Yes, it can be viewed in plain text and it’s application can be confirmed by entering the command “show running-config”. It’s application can also be confirmed by exiting “privileged EXEC” mode and running the command “enable”. If the shell asks for a password, then the “enable password …” command is confirmed to be successful.

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2.6 Answer to question 6

The same as with any computer that has its motherboard's clock battery removed and the main power supply cut off.
The progression of time can not be measured without power, and the clock resets on startup.

2.7 Answer to question 7

By sending the command "show startup-config" and ensuring that the reply "startup-config is not present" is written to the terminal.

2.8 Answer to question 8

Unauthorized users can enter "privileged EXEC" mode and thus change security related configurations[1].

2.9 Answer to question 9

Turning off the power supply and then turning it on again has to be done manually on site, unlike using the "reload" command which enables the operator to do it remotely or even automatically by setting schedule for the reload to take place[2].

2.10 Answer to question 9

In "privileged EXEC" mode, the user has access to all commands[3].
While "user EXEC" mode only gives access to a subset of commands.

1. https://www.cisco.com/en/US/docs/ios-xml/ios/sec_usr_cfg/configuration/15-1sg/sec-cfg-sec-4cli.html#GUID-1EEEC510-5B65-45D3-B827-5DD71F4F7218:~:text=access.-,Protecting,security.

2. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/td/docs/switches/lan/catalyst2960x/software/15_2_6_e/configuration_guide/b_1526e_consolidated_2960x_cg/m_sm_setup_cg_c2k.html#con_1072139:~:text=gateway%2E-,Scheduled%20Reload

3. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/td/docs/ios/sec_user_services/configuration/guide/12_4/sec_securing_user_services_12-4_book/sec_cfg_sec_4cli.html#:~:text=In%20order%20to%20have%20access%20to%20all%20commands

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3. Lab 3

This is the third and last lab assignment for the course “Data Communication and Networks” (DA541A HT26). Here I will answer a total of eight question regarding MAC tables, endpoints connected directly or transiently to a switch and basic fault isolation with the “ping” command.

All answers come from tests, tasks and experiments done in the environment referred to in the introduction to lab 1.

3.1 Answer to question 1

```
Switch>show mac address-table dynamic
          Mac Address Table
-------------------------------------------

Vlan    Mac Address       Type        Ports
----    -----------       --------    -----

   1    0030.a328.ec4b    DYNAMIC      Fa0/2
   1    0060.3e26.73d6    DYNAMIC      Fa0/1
Switch>
```

The switch’s MAC table provides the MAC addresses, the interfaces (ports), the VLAN and how the MAC addresses are learned (statically or dynamically) from the devices that have communicated through the switch.

3.2 Answer to question 2

The switch needs a MAC table so that it doesn’t need to rediscover the correct path every time an Ethernet frame comes to the switch.

Failing to have a MAC table causes a flood of unicast packages on the network[4].
A MAC table avoids this issue.

4. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/support/docs/switches/catalyst-6000-series-switches/23563-143.html#:~:text=When%20there%20is%20no%20entry

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3.3 Answer to question 3

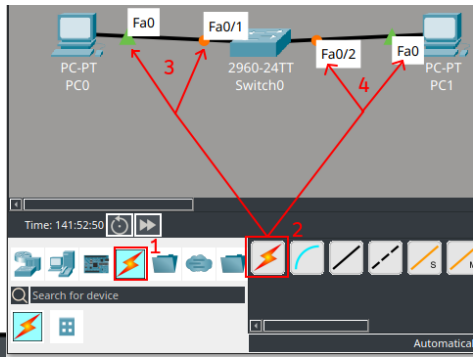
The switch learns of connected devices through the source MAC address of an incoming frame[5].

3.4 Answer to question 4

```
Switch>show mac address-table dynamic
          Mac Address Table
-------------------------------------------

Vlan    Mac Address       Type        Ports
----    -----------       --------    -----

   1    0030.a328.ec4b    DYNAMIC     Fa0/2
   1    0060.3e26.73d6    DYNAMIC     Fa0/1
Switch>
```



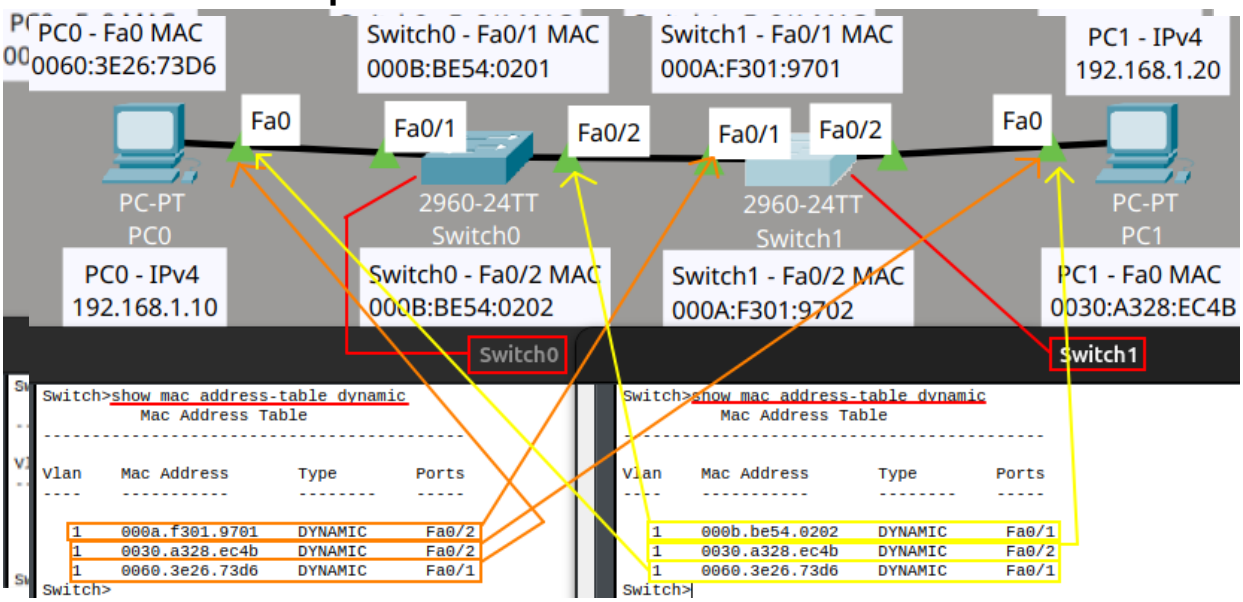
In Task 1, when the clients were connected to the same switch, the MAC table showed the MAC addresses of the Ethernet interfaces connected to the switch. I also observed that the printout of the MAC addresse were those of the interfaces on the device's end, and not the interfaces on the switch's end. I also observed their assigned VLAN, how the MAC addresses were learned and the ports on the switch that they were connected to.

5. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/support/docs/switches/catalyst-9300-switch/222771-understand-unexpected-mac-learning-on-ca.html?#:~:text=Catalyst%20switches%20learn%20MAC%20addresses%20on%20switch%20ports%20based%20on%20the%20source%20

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3.5 Answer to question 5

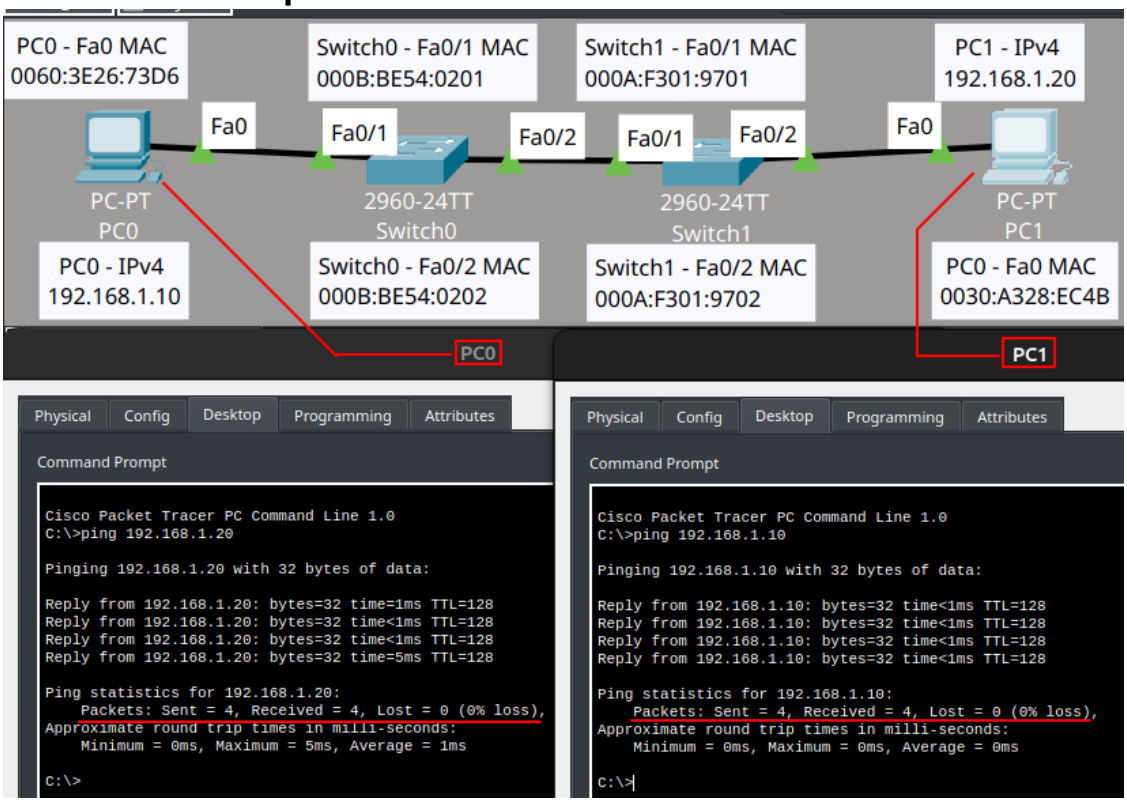


In Task 2, when the clients were connected to two different switches, the command “show mac address-table dynamic” printed the MAC addresses of the Ethernet interfaces connected, both directly and transiently, to the switch. In addition to what was observed in Task 1, I also observed that the printout of the MAC addresses where those of the interfaces on the device’s end, and not those on the switch’s end.

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3.6 Answer to question 6



The tool “ping” can be useful for fault isolation on a computer network and for sending a frame through the network so that the network’s switches can learn the source MAC of that frame in a non-production environment.

It tells me if a device on a network can receive and respond to a signal from my device. It can also serve as a tool for finding switches that fail to learn the MAC address of my device’s Ethernet interface in a controllable and repeatable way.

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3.7 Answer to question 7

There are several network issues on different layers of the OSI model that could cause a ping to fail.

On level 1: Defects on networking related hardware of different kinds. Examples are damaged Ethernet cables, and excessive electromagnetic noise[6].

On level 2: The Ethernet interfaces of the devices belonging to different VLAN's[7].

A switch disables a port on the route due to having blocked the connecting interface's MAC address[8].

On level 3: The IP addresses involved in the ping communication could be blocked by a firewall[9].

A device may be set to ignore all ICMP echo requests (the protocol that 'ping' uses)[10].

6. https://www.cisco.com/en/US/docs/internetworking/troubleshooting/guide/tr1904.html#:~:text=Excessive%20noise

7. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/support/docs/lan-switching/inter-vlan-routing/41260-189.html#:~:text=Layer%202%20%28L2%29%20switches%20need%20an%20L3%20routing%20device%20to%20facilitate%20communication%20between%20VLANs

8. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/td/docs/switches/lan/catalyst9300/software/release/17-5/configuration_guide/sec/b_175_sec_9300_cg/port_security.html#:~:text=the%20port%20does%20not%20forward%20packets%20with%20source%20addresses%20outside%20the%20group

9. https://docs.redhat.com/en/documentation/red_hat_enterprise_linux/7/html/security_guide/sec-managing_icmp_requests

10. https://kernel.org/doc/html/latest/networking/ip-sysctl.html#:~:text=icmp%5Fecho%5Fignore%5Fall

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3.8 Answer to question 8

The switch operates at 'OSI level 2'[11] and needs a MAC table in order to deliver its promise to manage the information in respect to the Ethernet interfaces connected to it and their VLAN's[12].

A hub operates at 'OSI level 1'[13] where it does not have any use for a MAC table and instead redistributes incoming signals to all its connected interfaces irrespective of who the signal was meant for[14].

11. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/support/docs/lan-switching/ethernet/12006-chapter22.html#:~:text=switch%20is%20considered%20a%20layer%2Dtwo%20device

12. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/support/docs/lan-switching/ethernet/12006-chapter22.html#:~:text=In%20order%20to%20know%20what%20to%20do%20with%20the%20frame%2C%20the%20switch%20learns%20the%20location%20of%20all%20devices%20on%20the%20segment

13. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/support/docs/lan-switching/ethernet/12006-chapter22.html#:~:text=a%20hub%20is%20considered%20a%20layer%2Done%20%28physical%20layer%29%20device

14. https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/support/docs/lan-switching/ethernet/12006-chapter22.html#:~:text=It%20hears%20an%20electrical%20signal%20on%20the%20wire%20and%20passes%20it%20along%20to%20the%20other%20ports